

COMPARABLES RESEARCH

A Proven Model

Land + Launch NWA

Real-world comparable programs — foundation- and nonprofit-backed — that validate the inclusive, cohort-based model SEED SPOT and Arkade propose for Northwest Arkansas. Outcomes, tracked metrics, and success narratives to support the concept paper and grant narrative.

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A proven category of philanthropic investment

Programs that welcome and support founders — including those from underrepresented backgrounds — and connect them into a regional innovation ecosystem are not a new idea. They are an established and growing category of philanthropic investment, present in communities across the country, including in Northwest Arkansas itself.

Foundation- and nonprofit-backed accelerators in Northwest Arkansas, Tulsa, and dozens of mid-size communities nationwide demonstrate measurable, mission-aligned results: founders welcomed and supported, businesses launched and grown, talent attracted and retained, and entrepreneurship made more accessible to people who have historically had less access to it.

Northwest Arkansas has proven demand for this model. The Walton Family Foundation's own investment in EforAll Northwest Arkansas shows what is possible when philanthropic capital backs inclusive entrepreneurship here. What the region has not yet built is a program designed for growth-stage founders — many building from outside the region — seeking to connect into Northwest Arkansas' anchor industries (consumer commerce, food and agriculture, and logistics and transportation) and put down roots. That is the gap Land + Launch NWA addresses.

The bottom line for the grant narrative: This is not an untested concept. It is a proven, mission-aligned category of philanthropic investment that delivers meaningful community impact — and one the Walton Family Foundation already supports in Northwest Arkansas. Land + Launch builds directly on that foundation, extending a welcoming, access-expanding model to the growth-stage founders who can connect most deeply with the industries that make the region distinct.

EforAll Northwest Arkansas

Location: Northwest Arkansas · **Key Supporter:** Walton Family Foundation · **Model:** Free, year-long inclusive business accelerator

Structure

EforAll (Entrepreneurship for All) Northwest Arkansas is a free, year-long accelerator that helps under-represented entrepreneurs launch and grow businesses through cohort-based programming, mentorship, and community support. It runs a Spanish-language sister program, EparaTodos, extending access to the region's Spanish-speaking founders. The program is a key part of the Walton Family Foundation's inclusive-entrepreneurship work in the region, with cumulative support that has topped \$1 million.

Outcomes

28 businesses launched since 2021	88% women-owned	74% BIPOC-owned
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- Free to participants, removing one of the most common barriers to entrepreneurial support
- Reaches Spanish-speaking founders through the EparaTodos program
- A model the Walton Family Foundation has chosen to back directly in Northwest Arkansas

Why It's Relevant

EforAll Northwest Arkansas is the clearest local proof that the Walton Family Foundation invests in inclusive, cohort-based entrepreneurship in the region — and that the model works here. Land + Launch NWA extends the same welcoming, access-expanding approach to a complementary segment: growth-stage founders building in the region's anchor industries, many arriving from outside Northwest Arkansas. The two efforts are complementary, not competing — EforAll supports early-stage local founders; Land + Launch connects growth-stage founders into the anchor-industry ecosystem and helps them put down roots.

Sources: EforAll Northwest Arkansas · EparaTodos · Walton Family Foundation

George Kaiser Family Foundation

Location: Tulsa, Oklahoma · **Operator:** George Kaiser Family Foundation (GKFF) · **Model:** Place-based family foundation investing in inclusive entrepreneurship and talent

Structure

The George Kaiser Family Foundation is a place-based family foundation that has made sustained, large-scale investments in welcoming people to Tulsa and supporting entrepreneurs — particularly those from underrepresented backgrounds. Its initiatives include Tulsa Remote (talent attraction), Build in Tulsa, and Avanzando Juntos, which supports Black and Latino entrepreneurs. Together they represent a long-term, foundation-led commitment to inclusive economic participation in a mid-size American region.

Outcomes

\$560M+ new employment income via Tulsa Remote	2 founder programs for Black & Latino entrepreneurs	10+ yrs sustained place-based investment
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- Tulsa Remote has generated more than \$560M in new employment income for the region
- Build in Tulsa and Avanzando Juntos extend entrepreneurship access to Black and Latino founders
- Demonstrates the compounding community value of patient, mission-aligned foundation capital

Why It's Relevant

GKFF is the closest peer model for what a place-based foundation can catalyze: patient, mission-aligned investment that welcomes people and founders into a region and helps them build there. It is a direct parallel to the role philanthropic investment can play in Northwest Arkansas — and a demonstration that sustained commitment to welcoming and supporting diverse founders generates lasting community benefit over time.

Sources: George Kaiser Family Foundation · Tulsa Remote · Build in Tulsa · Avanzando Juntos

gener8tor & gBETA

Location: National — 45+ communities across 25 states · **Operator:** gener8tor · **Model:** Free, non-equity accelerator backed by corporations, universities, and foundations

Structure

gener8tor's gBETA program is a free, non-equity accelerator funded by corporate, university, and foundation partners. It runs cohort-based programming across dozens of mid-size communities, deliberately expanding access to entrepreneurial support beyond the major coastal hubs. Because it takes no equity and charges founders nothing, it removes two of the most common barriers to early support.

Outcomes

45+ communities across 25 states	\$796M+ raised by alumni since 2015	\$0 cost to participating founders
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- Operating in 45+ communities across 25 states — proof the model travels well to mid-size markets
- Alumni companies have raised more than \$796M since 2015
- Non-equity and free to founders, backed by sponsors rather than participant fees

Why It's Relevant

gener8tor demonstrates that the free, cohort-based, sponsor-backed model is replicable and fundable across mid-size markets — exactly Northwest Arkansas' profile. Its scale across 25 states establishes this as a mature national category, and its non-equity, free-to-founder structure mirrors the access-expanding spirit of Land + Launch NWA.

Sources: gener8tor · gBETA program data

Why Northwest Arkansas

The comparable programs above are largely sector-agnostic. Land + Launch NWA is specifically positioned at the intersection of Northwest Arkansas' anchor industries and the dense ecosystem of suppliers, talent, and partners that surrounds them.

A rare concentration of industry

Five global headquarters anchor the region's core industries — consumer commerce (Walmart, Sam's Club), food and agriculture (Tyson Foods, Simmons Foods), and logistics and transportation (J.B. Hunt) — alongside more than 1,100 CPG brand offices. For a region of just over 600,000 residents, that is a rare concentration of industry density across multiple adjacent verticals, and it shapes a founder opportunity that few mid-size regions can match.

A welcoming community, still building its connective tissue

Northwest Arkansas pairs that industry density with rapid population growth, a growing talent pool, supportive regional civic leadership, and a strong quality of life. What is still developing are the intentional channels that connect growth-stage founders — including those arriving from outside the region — into the anchor-industry ecosystem, the local talent pool, and the relationships that make a sustained presence meaningful. That is the connective tissue Land + Launch is designed to build.

Complementary to what already exists

The region's existing entrepreneurial supports — including EforAll Northwest Arkansas — serve primarily early-stage and local founders. Land + Launch NWA does not duplicate that work. It serves a distinct, complementary segment: growth-stage founders building in commerce enablement, food and agriculture, and logistics and transportation who are ready to engage the anchor-industry ecosystem and explore Northwest Arkansas as a long-term home.

Land + Launch connects a proven, inclusive, foundation-backed model to the specific industries that make Northwest Arkansas distinct — welcoming growth-stage founders into a community already invested in expanding access to opportunity.

What the comparables tell us

PROGRAM	BACKING	REACH / OUTCOME	INCLUSIVE FOCUS
EforAll NWA	Walton Family Foundation	28 businesses launched since 2021	88% women · 74% BIPOC
GKFF / Tulsa	Place-based family foundation	\$560M+ new employment income	Black & Latino founder programs
gener8tor / gBETA	Corporate · university · foundation	\$796M+ alumni capital · 25 states	Free, non-equity, mid-size markets

01

NWA is not pioneering a new concept — it is building on a proven, mission-aligned one.

Foundation- and nonprofit-backed inclusive accelerators operate in Northwest Arkansas, Tulsa, and 45+ communities nationwide. This is an established and growing category of philanthropic investment, not an untested idea.

02

The Walton Family Foundation already invests in this model in Northwest Arkansas.

EforAll NWA is the strongest local proof — WFF-backed and delivering inclusive outcomes (88% women-owned, 74% BIPOC-owned). Land + Launch extends the same welcoming approach to growth-stage, anchor-industry founders, complementing rather than duplicating existing work.

03

Free, cohort-based, sponsor-backed programs expand access and produce real results.

gener8tor's \$796M+ in alumni capital across 25 states shows the model scales in mid-size markets, and its free, non-equity structure removes barriers that keep many founders from support.

04

Place-based philanthropy compounds over time.

GKFF and Tulsa demonstrate that sustained, patient foundation investment in welcoming people and founders generates lasting community value — a direct parallel to the role philanthropic capital can play in Northwest Arkansas.

Foundations and nonprofits nationwide — including the Walton Family Foundation in Northwest Arkansas — invest in inclusive, cohort-based entrepreneurship, and it works. Land + Launch builds on that, connecting welcomed founders to the industries that make Northwest Arkansas distinct.

Internal research · Arkade / KGC · June 2026 · Sources: EforAll NWA · George Kaiser Family Foundation · gener8tor / gBETA · Walton Family Foundation